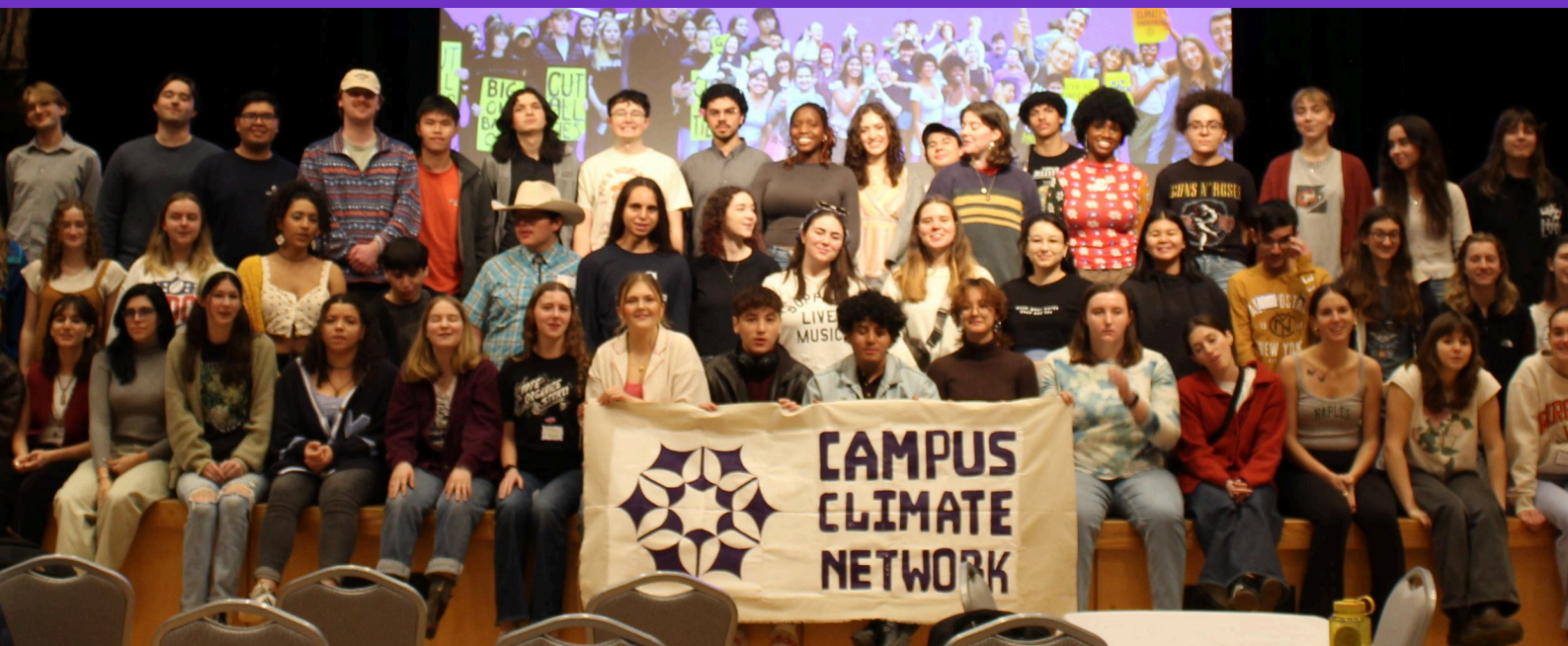




CAMPUS CLIMATE NETWORK

Impact Report 2025



Note from the Executive Director

In 2025, we confronted the intersections between climate justice, democracy, and higher education. International and undocumented students were kidnapped in broad daylight, hundreds of millions of dollars in public research funding were cancelled, and widespread measures were taken to restrict academic freedom. These measures are consistent with those of authoritarian leaders throughout history.

Big Oil stands to benefit from Trump's bid to capture US universities. There is no just energy transition under authoritarianism. History has taught us that authoritarian leaders seek to capture universities in order to consolidate power. By standing up to Trump, universities can play a role in defending our right to a democratic, liveable future. Students have the power to ensure universities stand on the right side of history.

While several CCN members maintained pressure on their universities to cut ties with Big Oil and center climate justice, others were called to channel their efforts toward defending their campuses against authoritarian capture. The CCN team supported students on both fronts. The leaders we've developed and the relational infrastructure we've built over the past three years proved foundational to the victories we celebrated in 2025. The further investments we made in developing student leaders this year will prove foundational to the achievements of our movement in 2026 and beyond.

The stakes of developing a skilled, connected, and winning student climate movement cannot be exaggerated. The student climate movement has the potential to play a decisive role in the fight for a democratic, just, and livable, future. This potential is not guaranteed. At CCN, we remain steadfast in our commitment to realizing the full potential of student power.



Jake Lowe
Executive Director



Our mission

Campus Climate Network is **building power in the US student climate movement.**

We are building a coalition of student-led climate justice groups fighting to **cut ties with the fossil fuel industry** and its enablers.

We provide students with the training, resources, and connections they need to run **winning campaigns** on campus and become the **next generation of climate justice leaders.**

What we achieved

We kicked big oil off campus and resisted authoritarianism

Equipped with CCN's coaching, resources, and network, member organizations delivered big wins against the fossil fuel industry & attacks on higher education.

BP OFF CAMPUS



Princeton ended a decade-long partnership with BP following pressure from Sunrise Princeton

FOSSIL FREE CAREERS



MIT careers fair did not include any fossil fuel companies for the first time ever due to organizing from MIT Divest

FOSSIL FREE RESEARCH



Monash University in Australia passed a Fossil Free Research policy following pressure from Stop Woodside Monash

PUSHING BACK ON TRUMP

No university complied with the Trump compact.

7 schools rejected it.

MIT
Brown
UPenn
USC
Dartmouth
University of Virginia
University of Arizona

PRESS COVERAGE

STUDENTS RISE UP

Garnered international media coverage for nationwide Day of Action with over 100 universities and thousands of students participating

We pushed universities to reject Trump's demands

In October, the Trump administration sent a "Loyalty Oath Compact" to nine US universities, offering special treatment in exchange for allegiance to a partisan ideological agenda. It targeted marginalized students, threatened academic freedom, and would have prevented universities from adopting future policies to cut ties with Big Oil.

Less than 24 hours after the compact was announced, we were organizing with students on all nine campuses.

Because of our efforts, not a single university accepted the compact. Seven of the original nine schools rejected it outright, and ten others proactively said they do not support the compact.



How we did it

We reached more students than ever before

1,300+

students trained

through workshops, campus gatherings, and online teach-ins



22

new student groups

in the CCN coalition representing 18 states

24

organizing fellows

in our semester long program, which offered financial support for fellows

289

coaching sessions

with students, providing one-on-one support and leadership development

88

group trainings

of which 50 were online and 38 in-person, across 20 different campuses.

3

nationwide protests

with over 100 universities participating representing thousands of students across the country



We developed committed organizers through rigorous, tailored trainings

Students shared that working with CCN equipped them with the resources, skills, and connections to win campaigns in the face of unprecedented challenges.



"Having the support and guidance of incredible organizers has been both helpful and inspiring. It's empowering to know there's a community of people who genuinely want to see you grow and succeed."

Devin Morgan

University of Richmond, 2025 CCN Organizing Fellow



"It's been great to be in community with people that are also navigating such a rough political moment on campuses."

Amy Okonkwo

UNC Chapel Hill, CCN Planning Committee Elected Rep



"CCN is a fantastic organization, and they have really impacted my college organizing experience."

Sarah Reuben-Hallock

University of Kansas, 2025 CCN Organizing Fellow

We built partnerships across the ecosystem



Leadership development with Climate Resistance Incubator (CRI)

CCN staff leaders receive regular coaching and support from Varshini Prakash, co-founder and former Executive Director of Sunrise Movement.



Produced critical research with University of Miami Climate Accountability Lab (CAL)

28 students from CCN member organizations worked with Geoffrey Supran, CCN Advisory Board Member, to uncover connections between universities and fossil fuel companies.

Coordinated national efforts with students and workers at Project Rise Up (PRU)

CCN joined and organized with PRU, a coalition of labor and student-led organizations across the country, to fight back against rising authoritarianism on campus.



HIGHER ED LABOR UNITED



aaup
AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF
UNIVERSITY PROFESSORS



**FRONTLINE FOR
FREEDOM**

YOUTH ACTION FUND

We doubled our team and expanded paid student roles

Our growing team allowed us to provide higher quality support for the students in our movement.

4

New staff

7

New trainers

10

New coaches

The CCN Team



Thank you!

Contact

info@campusclimatenetwork.org

campusclimatenetwork.org